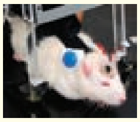
SHORTS

TWITTER IS QUITE USELESS

Renowned author Malcolm Gladwell puts up a convincing case on how so-called social activism on Twitter and Facebook is quite hollow when compared to real social movements in the past.

http://nyr.kr/9Y92DZ

BRAIN-MACHINE INTERFACE



Experiments in this field have been going on for some time. The latest is from the University of Tokyo where they've made this rat control a little car with his mind.

http://bit.ly/cdlgkU

NANOWRIMO GUIDE

Don't understand what you just read up there? It stands for National Novel Writing Month, a monumental project that gets participants to write an entire 50,000 word novel in a month. Here's a Wired Wiki to teach you how.

http://bit.ly/c23eZ1

THE BATTLE RAGES ON

US citizens could soon find themselves joining Iranians and Chinese in being blocked from accessing broad chunks of the public Internet. Have a look at this report and the supporting petition. What is interesting though is that Demonoid is supporting it!

http://huff.to/aOlcAv

ExtremeTech: Overclocking Guide 2010

- By Joel Durham Jr. *and* Denny Atkin

If you use your computer for any demanding tasks such as gaming, video editing, or transcoding, there's little reason not to overclock. You'll get faster frame rates, quicker renders, and the performance of a system costing hundreds of dollars more. How can you say no to that?

The Overall Overclocking Technique

Before disclosing the basic overclocking technique that works for everything, there's one word we really want you to become familiar with: stability.

The key to a successful overclock is being able to use the computer when you're done. That means: You can play games, crunch numbers, transcode video, sync your iPod, or whatever, without the PC locking up, crashing, or suddenly rebooting. If the PC isn't stable, your overclock is a failure.

Anyone can say they got their 2.66-GHz CPU up to 4 GHz with the stock cooler if all it did was POST before it crashed, or even if it ran Windows but crashed when you moved the mouse. We're going to talk about stability testing, which is one of the necessary steps of overclocking. Passing a stability test is mandatory before you can say you've overclocked anything.

Our technique for overclocking any part (we'll get into specifics later) is simple:

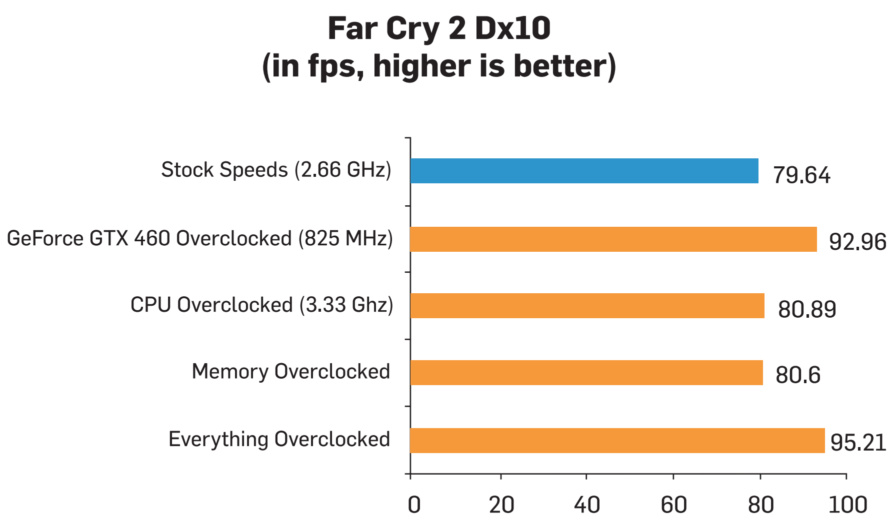
1. Tweak. Raise the clock frequency just a small amount. Overclocking requires baby steps. If you're overclocking a multiplier-unlocked CPU, raise it one number at a time. Raise the Base Clock maybe five to ten megahertz at a time. Same with the graphics core and/or memory. And also, don't change two settings at once.

2. Boot. Watch the system as it boots. Does it POST? Is the RAM count correct? Does the boot take longer than it usually does? Watch for any signs that your computer isn't acting normally; they could be signs of instability.

3. Test. Run a stability test. We usually test CPUs and memory with Prime95 (running one instance per core) for 30 minutes. We prefer to test GPUs by playing a nice, long session of a very recent, graphically intense game. You can also set 3DMark Vantage to loop its Extreme test, but a video card stability test is more effective if you're constantly watching the screen for glitches.

4. Repeat. In other words, return to step 1. If the overclock passes your stability test, raise the frequency or multiplier further.

If Step 3 fails, drop back a notch and run the stability test again. Once you've found the absolute fastest frequencies your computer's components can run, you've completed your overclocking experiment.



If you had any doubts about why to Overclock, here's why.

Note: Read these charts knowing that the overclocks they show are modest ones, and they're up just for the sake of argument. Imagine what you could do if you really pushed your stuff!